OLED vs LCD

facturers instead use VA panel variants such as AHVA which provides colour fidelity which comes very close to what IPS panels provide.

Also, the new fad is to have thinner panels. You'll see terms such as "IGZO" being used. This is simply the substrate onto which panels are made. Using IGZO facilitates thinner panels. Also, OLEDs are becoming affordable by the day and we've started seeing laptops starting around ₹60-70K featuring OLED panels. The colour reproduction and black levels on OLED makes pictures come to life. So if you are going to use the laptop for media consumption, then an OLED panel would be a nice thing to have.

Touchscreens, on the other hand, aren't all that impressive. You'd be better off getting a better panel without touchscreen functionality than a duller panel with touchscreen functionality.

Resolution also matters if you want crispier images. Since a laptop is used at a much closer distance to your face than a PC monitor, you are likely to notice visual artifacts. To avoid that, it's better to get a higher resolution panel. Laptops around ₹45K onwards will feature high-resolution panels. Anything running higher than 1920x1080 on a 14-inch display should do good.

7. TOUCHPAD

If you plan on using your laptop primarily for work with little need for multimedia work, then a big touchpad is a luxury. The touchpads on all laptops ship with gesture recognition so if you're interested in improving your productivity then learning gestures will help.

As for gaming, you're better off using a separate keyboard and mouse. If not the keyboard, then at least get a separate mouse. Having additional touch buttons on the

Numpad reinvented

touchpad is preferred over having physical buttons since those tend to give out sooner.

8. KEYBOARD

Just like the touchpad, the keyboard is very much a personal thing. If your work becomes easier with a numpad, then opt for laptops with numpads. Your choices would have only been 15.6-inch laptops (or larger) since only those were wide enough to host a keyboard with a numpad. Of late, we've seen some interesting designs in the laptop space. Especially with the touchpad that doubles up as a numpad with the press of a button. You don't get the same feel of using a proper numpad, but it's certainly a beter experience than no numpad at all!

Then there are the gaming laptops with mechanical switches. Treat these as a pure luxury. There are barely 2-3 models available in the country with actual mechanical switches and they all cost a lot so there's little value for money over there.

9. CHASSIS

It is common to find the little bits of plastic right next to the hinges on laptops to come off after a couple of years of usage. Unfortunately, in most cases, this happens after the warranty period on the laptops has expired. This is why metal is the best choice for the chassis. They'll last for ages. and you'll not have little bits coming apart from the chassis.

The problem with metal is that they tend to conduct heat better. Ordinarily, this would been seen as a huge plus point but with laptops, this means that the touch surfaces become too hot. Unless the heatsink is designed in such a way that the conductive parts are insulated from the surfaces, you might end up with minor burns on your lap. Thankfully, you can alter the power plans or tweak the TDP of the GPUs in laptops to reduce heat generation without a significant loss in performance.

10. CONNECTIVITY

You need not make interfaces a huge part of your purchase decision. There are hundreds of USB hubs out there that allow you to expand the connectivity options on your laptop. If you have even one USB Type-C port that's capable of power delivery, then getting a good hub would be preferred over spending more money upgrading to a higher spec laptop with all the bells and whistles. A good hub with support for 100W USB Type-C Power Delivery with every interface that

Enjoy the hub life

you can dream of costs about 3-5K, so that's a very economical way of getting more interfaces.

That should be enough for you to make a more informed decision with regards to your next laptop purchase. In the next story, we'll look at PC peripherals, one of the most replaced components of a PC.